Elevate
QUALITY COMPLIANCE SOLUTIONS

**ST-DLV-005**

# Startup Compliance Roadmap

*Aligned with applicable standards and best practices | Version 1.0 | Elevate Quality Compliance Solutions LLC*

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|---|---|---|
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## 1 Purpose & How to Use This Roadmap

This Compliance Roadmap provides a phased action plan for building a legally sound, operationally mature, and investor-ready compliance function. It is designed for startups from pre-seed through Series A. Activities are grouped into four phases aligned with typical growth milestones. Update status as each item progresses.

> 📋 **HOW TO USE:** *Customize the timeline columns to match your company's funding stage and planning horizon. Update the STATUS field for each item. Items marked CRITICAL should be addressed before customer contracts are signed or funding is closed. Share this roadmap with your board and investors as evidence of compliance maturity.*

## 2 Company & Roadmap Details

| Company Name | Current Funding Stage | Roadmap Owner |
|---|---|---|
| *Enter name* | *Pre-Seed / Seed / Series A / Series B* | *Enter name/title* |

| Phase 1 | Phase 2 | Phase 3 | Phase 4 |
|---|---|---|---|
| Foundation (Pre-Seed / Month 0–3) | Structuring (Seed / Month 3–9) | Scaling (Series A / Month 9–18) | Maturity (Series B+ / Month 18+) |

## 3 Compliance Roadmap Activities

| Phase | Compliance Activity | Priority | Owner | Status | Notes / Target Date |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| **LEGAL & CORPORATE STRUCTURE** | | | | | |
| Phase 1 | Incorporate company and establish registered agent | CRITICAL | CEO/Legal | NOT STARTED | |
| Phase 1 | Draft and sign founder agreements and IP assignment | CRITICAL | Legal | NOT STARTED | |
| Phase 1 | Establish basic terms of service and privacy policy | CRITICAL | Legal/CTO | NOT STARTED | *Ref: LEGAL-004/005* |
| Phase 1 | Execute NDA template for all third-party discussions | HIGH | Legal | NOT STARTED | *Ref: LEGAL-002* |
| Phase 2 | Engage employment counsel; review contractor classification | HIGH | Legal/HR | PLANNED | |
| Phase 2 | Implement IP protection strategy (TM, patents, trade secrets) | HIGH | Legal | PLANNED | |
| Phase 3 | Establish board governance and meeting cadence | HIGH | CEO/Board | PLANNED | *Ref: CORP-002* |
| Phase 4 | Full legal entity review; international expansion compliance | MEDIUM | Legal | PLANNED | |
| **DATA PRIVACY & SECURITY** | | | | | |

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| Phase | Compliance Activity | Priority | Owner | Status | Notes / Target Date |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| **Phase 1** | Define data classification — what data do you collect and store? | **CRITICAL** | CTO/CEO | **NOT STARTED** | *Ref: SEC-008* |
| **Phase 1** | Implement basic access controls and MFA on all systems | **CRITICAL** | CTO | **NOT STARTED** | *Ref: SEC-002* |
| **Phase 1** | Ensure GDPR / CCPA privacy notice and cookie policy live | **CRITICAL** | Legal/CTO | **NOT STARTED** | *Ref: LEGAL-004/006* |
| **Phase 2** | Implement data backup and recovery procedure | **HIGH** | CTO | **PLANNED** | *Ref: SEC-003* |
| **Phase 2** | Sign Data Processing Agreements (DPAs) with vendors | **HIGH** | Legal/CTO | **PLANNED** | |
| **Phase 2** | Develop incident response procedure | **HIGH** | CTO | **PLANNED** | *Ref: SEC-005* |
| **Phase 3** | Conduct first external penetration test | **HIGH** | CTO | **PLANNED** | |
| **Phase 3** | Begin SOC 2 Type I readiness | **MEDIUM** | CTO/COO | **PLANNED** | |
| **Phase 4** | Achieve SOC 2 Type II or ISO 27001 certification | **MEDIUM** | CTO | **PLANNED** | |
| **OPERATIONAL COMPLIANCE** | | | | | |
| **Phase 1** | Document top 5 core business processes as SOPs | **CRITICAL** | COO/CEO | **NOT STARTED** | *Ref: ST-DLV-001* |
| **Phase 1** | Set up basic financial controls and expense policy | **HIGH** | CFO/CEO | **NOT STARTED** | *Ref: FIN-001/004* |
| **Phase 2** | Establish vendor management and onboarding checklist | **HIGH** | COO | **PLANNED** | *Ref: OPS-009* |
| **Phase 2** | Implement client onboarding and offboarding procedures | **HIGH** | COO | **PLANNED** | *Ref: OPS-002* |
| **Phase 2** | Document escalation and issue management process | **MEDIUM** | COO | **PLANNED** | *Ref: OPS-008* |
| **Phase 3** | Implement full QMS with quality policy and corrective action | **MEDIUM** | COO | **PLANNED** | *Ref: QMS-001/003* |
| **Phase 3** | Conduct first internal process audit | **MEDIUM** | COO | **PLANNED** | *Ref: QMS-004* |
| **Phase 4** | Begin ISO 9001:2015 gap assessment and certification readiness | **LOW** | COO | **PLANNED** | *Ref: ST-SERV-006* |
| **HR & PEOPLE COMPLIANCE** | | | | | |
| **Phase 1** | Establish employment / contractor agreement templates | **CRITICAL** | Legal/HR | **NOT STARTED** | *Ref: LEGAL-003* |
| **Phase 2** | Implement code of conduct and ethics policy | **HIGH** | CEO/HR | **PLANNED** | *Ref: CORP-006* |
| **Phase 2** | Create employee handbook covering key policies | **HIGH** | HR | **PLANNED** | *Ref: CORP-010* |

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| Phase | Compliance Activity | Priority | Owner | Status | Notes / Target Date |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Phase 2 | Document onboarding process for new hires | HIGH | HR | PLANNED | *Ref: OPS-002* |
| Phase 3 | Implement performance review and competence framework | MEDIUM | HR | PLANNED | *Ref: QMS-009* |
| Phase 3 | Whistleblower / non-retaliation policy published | MEDIUM | Legal/HR | PLANNED | *Ref: HRA-001* |
| Phase 4 | EEOC / ADA compliance review | LOW | Legal/HR | PLANNED | *Ref: HRA-002* |
| **FINANCIAL & TAX COMPLIANCE** | | | | | |
| Phase 1 | Engage accountant / CPA; set up chart of accounts | CRITICAL | CFO/CEO | NOT STARTED | *Ref: FIN-006* |
| Phase 1 | Register for applicable state and local taxes | CRITICAL | CFO/Legal | NOT STARTED | |
| Phase 2 | Implement revenue recognition policy | HIGH | CFO | PLANNED | *Ref: FIN-002* |
| Phase 2 | Establish AR/AP procedures and collections policy | HIGH | CFO | PLANNED | *Ref: FIN-007* |
| Phase 3 | Conduct first financial audit or reviewed financials | HIGH | CFO | PLANNED | *Required for Series A* |
| Phase 4 | Implement full financial risk management framework | MEDIUM | CFO | PLANNED | *Ref: FIN-005* |
| **INVESTOR READINESS** | | | | | |
| Phase 1 | Maintain a current, clean cap table | CRITICAL | CEO/Legal | NOT STARTED | |
| Phase 2 | Compile investor compliance summary pack | HIGH | CEO/COO | PLANNED | *Ref: ST-DLV-007* |
| Phase 2 | Document IP ownership clearly in data room | HIGH | Legal | PLANNED | |
| Phase 3 | Complete operational maturity model self-assessment | HIGH | COO | PLANNED | *Ref: ST-DLV-008* |
| Phase 3 | Prepare board governance documentation | MEDIUM | CEO/Board | PLANNED | *Ref: CORP-002* |
| Phase 4 | Achieve at least one formal compliance certification | MEDIUM | COO | PLANNED | *SOC 2 / ISO 9001* |

## 4 Roadmap Progress Summary

| Complete | In Progress | Planned | Not Started | Total Items |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| ____ | ____ | ____ | ____ | ____ |

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